

VIETNAM

Vietnam's monsoon climate creates the perfect natural conditions for growing tea. Harvests are abundant, making Vietnam the sixth largest tea producer in the world.

The indigenous wild tea tree, or “shan,” has been growing in Vietnam for at least 1,000 years. However, it was only in the 1820s that tea plantations were established by French immigrants. Production experienced a setback during the troubled years following World War II, but has since seen a strong recovery. Some regional specialty teas, such as Ha Giang and Shan Tuyet green tea and lotus blossom tea, are grown in the northern area of Vietnam. These teas are being promoted by the Vietnam Tea Association (VITAS) at tea markets worldwide to help farmers increase their income. Producers mostly use the orthodox (whole leaf) method of tea production, as well as some CTC (see p21).



VIETNAM KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE
OF WORLD
PRODUCTION: **4.8%**

FAMOUS FOR:
INDIGENOUS
PLANTS

HARVEST:
MARCH–OCTOBER

MAIN TYPES:
GREEN,
LOTUS FLOWER, BLACK

ELEVATION:
MEDIUM